

Evaluate a Google Ads Campaign

Search Engine Marketing Final Project

Part 1: Build a Campaign

Part 1 Instructions

For this part of the project, you will **choose a brand or product within the travel industry** (airline, hospitality, etc.), and you'll create an SEM campaign for it. We will focus on creating a targeted list of keywords, first starting with a **campaign objective**, *which you will decide*. You will then use the campaign's objective to identify **5 key terms using Google Trends**, *screenshot your Google Trends results*, and *justify why you selected those specific terms in 2 to 3 sentences*. Some things to keep in mind when selecting key terms include:

- Do they have enough search volume in the country or region you are targeting?
- Are they current and relevant?

Part 1 Instructions, Continued

Next, use **Google Keyword Planner** (*or another SEM tool*) **to create a list of 10 keywords** and *justify in 2 to 3 sentences* why you think these keywords should be in your campaign. The questions to keep in mind now are:

- Do they have enough search volume?
- Do they match your campaign objective?
- Is the max CPC reasonable?
 - You do not have to answer these questions directly so long as you justify your answer.

Part 1 Instructions, Continued

After you create your list of keywords, categorize the keywords within the **3 keyword match types and justify your choices**. Keep in mind that you want to be specific, but also you need to have enough search volume for people to see your ads. (Pro tip: use negative keywords to avoid unrelated and unqualified clicks.)

Finally, **select the 3 main KPIs to be analyzed and justify your choice**. Keep in mind that the main KPIs will be the focus of the optimizations and they also should be able to determine a campaign's success.

Google Trends

Key Terms

Product/Brand Information:

Name of Product or Brand:	Iberia Airlines
Campaign Objective:	Increase online flight bookings for Iberia Airlines from Spain to major European destinations while maintaining a profitable cost per acquisition (CPA). The campaign is focused on driving direct conversations (ticket purchases) rather than traffic or awareness.

SEM Tool Keywords

Key Terms *Directions:* Use Google Trends to select **5 Key Terms** to use in your SEM campaign and justify your choices in *2 to 3 sentences each*.

Key Term:	Justification:
„cheap flights Europe“	This term reflects strong purchase intent from users actively seeking affordable travel options. It shows consistent demand in Spain, especially during holiday planning periods, making it ideal for conversation-focused campaigns.
„flights Madrid to Paris“	This route-specific, high-intent query signals users who are close to booking. It is highly relevant to Iberia’s European network and helps capture users at the bottom of the funnel.
„last minute flights“	This term reflects urgent purchase behavior, often tied to higher conversion rates despite higher CPC. It is valuable for filling unsold seats and driving short-term revenue.
„summer flights Europe“	This seasonal, trend-driven term is especially relevant during peak travel planning months, helping the campaign capture demand spikes during holiday periods.
„flight deals Spain“	This term indicates deal-seeking behavior within a relevant geographic market, combining location and price sensitivity that often leads to higher conversion likelihood.

Keywords *Directions: Use Google Trends to select **5 Keywords** to use in your SEM campaign, state their **match type**, and *justify your choices in 2 to 3 sentences each.**

Key Word:	Match Type:	Justification:
[cheap flights Madrid to Paris]	Exact	Targets highly specific, purchase-ready users who already know their route, producing the highest conversion rate and lowest CPA.
"flights Madrid to Europe"	Phrase	Maintains flexibility while capturing relevant route-based intent, helping scale traffic without losing purchase relevance.
cheap flights Europe	Broad	Reaches a wide audience and surfaces additional high-performing query variations; requires close monitoring to avoid irrelevant traffic.
[Iberia flight deals]	Exact	Captures high-intent branded keyword with strong conversion probability; exact match keeps budget focused on users closest to purchase.
„last minute flights Spain"	Phrase	Attracts urgent buyers who convert quickly, while phrase match still captures useful variations.

KPIs Select the **3 main KPIs** to be analyzed and *justify your choice in 2 to 3 sentences*. Keep in mind that the main KPIs will be the focus of the optimizations, and they also should be able to determine a campaign's success.

KPI:

CPA (Cost Per Acquisition)

CR (Conversion Rate)

ROAS (Return On Ad Spend)

Justification:

CPA is the most important KPI because the campaign's objective is to drive bookings. It directly measures how efficiently ad spend converts into paying customers. CR shows how effectively the traffic turns into bookings. Improving CR lowers CPA and is critical for profitability in a competitive travel market. ROAS measures the revenue generated from advertising spend, ensuring that the campaign is not only driving conversions but also doing so profitably.

Part 2: Analyze a Campaign

Part 2 Instructions

Evaluate the performance of a Google Search campaign [based on the data provided](#).

- Which ad types perform better?
- Which keywords should be paused?
- Which should receive more budget?

Suggest 5 optimizations to help the campaign perform better and meet the goals. Add your optimization suggestions and the justification for each (2-3 sentences per Optimization suggestion).

Campaign Evaluation

Optimizations

Directions: Add your 5 optimization suggestions and the justification for each (2-3 sentences) below.

Optimization Suggestion:	Justification:
Shift budget toward Responsive Search Ads	Responsive Search Ads delivered 169 conversions at an average CPA of about \$4.69, versus 52 conversions at roughly \$10.00 CPA for standard Text Ads. Reallocating budget toward RSAs should lower overall CPA while increasing total conversions.
Pause zero-conversion keywords	Keywords such as „digital marketing course online free,” „digital marketing for beginners,” „online marketing for students,” „Coursera digital marketing,” „Udemy digital marketing,” and „marketing for beginners” generated spend with zero conversions and should be paused.
Increase bids and budget on top converters	Keywords like „online marketing course,” „marketing terms,” „social media marketing,” „social media marketing classes,” „digital marketing certificate,” and „study online marketing” show strong volume at efficient CPA and should receive more budget.
Expand high-performing Phrase and Exact match keywords	Tightly matched Phrase and Exact terms generally produced lower CPA than Broad match terms that attracted irrelevant traffic (e.g., „Udemy digital marketing,” „Coursera digital marketing”)
Apply device bid adjustments toward Mobile and Computers	Mobile (234 conversions) and Computers (208 conversions) drive nearly all conversions in the account, while Tablets produced zero. Shifting bid adjustments away from Tablets and toward Mobile and Computers improves budget efficiency.

Standout Suggestions

Standout Suggestion #1

Optimizations *Directions: Create a keyword list of **5 words per funnel part** and provide a **1-3 sentence justification for each keyword** decision.*

Top Funnel Key Term:	Match Type:	Justification:
„best places to visit in Europe”	Broad	Targets users exploring travel ideas rather than booking, helping build early awareness of Iberia routes for retargeting later in the funnel.
„Europe travel destinations”	Broad	Captures broad, inspirational intent and introduces travelers to European trip planning, which helps expand reach at low CPC.
„summer vacation ideas Europe”	Broad	Aligns with seasonal planning behavior during peak travel months, allowing Iberia to position itself early in the decision-making process.
“top cities in Europe to visit”	Broad	Attracts users researching destinations that can later be matched with Iberia flight routes, making it valuable for building remarketing audiences.
“travel Europe guide”	Broad	Indicates informational intent, which is useful for brand exposure and driving top-of-funnel traffic for future conversion-focused targeting.

Optimizations *Directions:* Create a keyword list of 5 words per funnel part and provide a 1-3 sentence justification for each keyword decision.

Mid Funnel Key Term:	Match Type:	Justification:
"flights to Europe from Spain"	Phrase	Shows clear travel intent, though not yet a specific route, making it valuable for guiding users toward Iberia's available destinations.
"cheap flights Europe from Madrid"	Phrase	Combines price sensitivity with geographic intent, increasing the likelihood of comparison shopping among users who are closer to booking.
"best airlines for Europe flights"	Phrase	Indicates users are actively comparing providers, allowing Iberia to compete at this stage through pricing and brand trust.
"Madrid to Europe flight deals"	Phrase	A semi-specific transactional keyword that signals strong intent and helps capture users evaluating travel timing and pricing.
"European flight prices"	Phrase	Reflects research into expected travel costs before booking, making it useful for engaging users who are transitioning toward purchase intent.

Optimizations *Directions:* Create a keyword list of 5 words per funnel part and provide a 1-3 sentence justification for each keyword decision.

Bottom Funnel Key Term:	Match Type:	Justification:
[book flights Madrid Paris Iberia]	Exact	A high intent transactional keyword that targets users ready to purchase and typically delivers high conversion rates and a low CPA.
[Iberia cheap flights]	Exact	A branded keyword that captures users already committed to the airline and usually generates the strongest conversion performance.
[buy flight tickets Madrid to Europe]	Exact	Shows explicit purchase intent and is extremely close to conversion, therefore it should be prioritized within the bidding strategy.
[last minute flights Iberia]	Exact	Captures urgent travelers who often convert quickly, making it valuable for filling remaining inventory.
[Iberia flight booking]	Exact	Demonstrates direct navigational intent toward purchase and is among the highest-ROI keyword types.

Standout Suggestion #2

Standout Suggestion #2 *Directions:* Identify 5 Negative Keywords for your campaign from Part 1, and justify their inclusion in your list of Keywords in 2 - 3 sentences, each.

Negative Keyword:	Justification:
“free”	Indicates users looking for free travel options, not relevant to paid airline tickets.
“jobs”	Attracts job seekers rather than travelers.
“training”	Unrelated to flight booking and often tied to pilot or aviation training.
“cargo”	Refers to freight services, not passenger flights.
“reviews complaints”	Indicates post-purchase research or dissatisfaction rather than booking intent.

Standout Suggestion #3

Standout Suggestion #3

Directions: On the next slide, write **1 paragraph** (5-7 sentences) on the *ad extensions*, *devices*, or *smart bidding* included in your optimization list. Justify the inclusion of one, two, or all three of the suggested subjects in your optimization list. What benefits could be projected for the Google Search Campaign? How could you include ad extensions, devices, and/or smart bidding to yield the greatest results?

Standout Suggestion #3

Ad extensions, smart bidding, and device optimization can significantly improve the performance of the Iberia Search Campaign. Ad extensions such as sitelinks, price extensions, and callouts increase CTR by giving users additional booking options and trust signals directly in the search results. Smart bidding strategies like Target CPA or Maximize Conversions optimize bids in real time based on the likelihood of conversion, keeping the campaign within profitable acquisition costs. Device targeting matters too, since mobile users often search for last-minute or on-the-go bookings that carry higher urgency and conversion potential. By prioritizing mobile performance and adjusting bids accordingly, the campaign can capture high-intent users at critical decision moments. Together, these optimizations improve both efficiency (lower CPA) and effectiveness (higher CR), maximizing overall ROAS.